

Board 2
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 9 3
♥ 6 5 2
♦ J 10 4 2
♣ J 10 8 5

♠ K J 10
♥ A Q 7
♦ A 7 5
♣ A Q 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 4
♦ K Q 6 3
♣ K 3 2

♠ 8 7 6 4 2
♥ 10 9 8 3
♦ 9 8
♣ 9 6

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2NT	Pass	7NT

All Pass

7NT by North

two suits will have to split 3-3, so they will immediately test one, then the other.

In fact there is another possibility for success - even if neither suit is 3-3 it may be that the same defender holds 4 cards in both suits. In this case that defender can be squeezed. BUT, you don't play the ♣s and ♦s first, you play the other two suits.

Win the first ♥, then play two more ♥s and all three ♠ winners. That will be 6 tricks played, and each defender will be down to 7 cards left in their hand. If one of them happened to start with 4 ♣s and 4 ♦s he will have to discard from one of the holdings and you will be able to win your fourth card in that suit.

Although neither minor suit splits 3-3 it happens that West holds the guard in both suits.

When you play your sixth Major suit winner West is squeezed and must discard from one of his 4-card holdings.

This is an Automatic Squeeze, which just means you don't have to do any preparatory work. All you have to do is play off all your non-threat winners before you play the squeezing suits.

Partner has 20 or 21 points, balanced, and you have 18. You've always wanted to do this haven't you?

The contract would be 7NT played by South.

North plays 7NT. East leads the ♥10 and West follows with the ♥2.

DO NOT HOLD UP.

Winner List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 12

There are two chances for your thirteenth winner, your fourth ♣ or dummy's fourth ♦.

Some players will assume that means one of those

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 9 8 7 5 4

♥ 7 5 4

♦ 9 8 6

♣ Q

♠ A 6

♥ K 9 2

♦ K J 3

♣ J 8 7 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 3

♥ A 8 6

♦ Q 7 5 2

♣ A K 9 4

♠ J 10 2

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ A 10 4

♣ 10 6 5

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

1NT

Pass

All Pass

2♠ by East

7

Surely this hand will play better in ♠s than in notrump. So you transfer with 2♥ and partner bids 2♠.

Surely this hand will play better in ♠s than in notrump. So you transfer with 2♥ and partner bids 2♠.

You pass. In the old days, before transfers, you would have bid 2♠ with this hand as a sign-off. The only difference is that now partner gets to play it.

The contract would be 2♠ played by West.

East plays 2♠. South leads the ♥Q and North plays the ♥9.

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 0 :: Total =

Suppose you win the ♥A, play over to the ♣Q, then try to get back to your hand with a trump to discard 2 losers on ♣ A K. If it worked that way it would be fine, but it is very likely that a defender would win their trump Ace, then take their 2 ♥s and 3 ♦s. You could be down one before you even got started.

A better approach is to trade one of your ♣ winners for a quick discard. Take the ♥A, then play ♣ A K, discarding a ♥ from dummy. That will eliminate one ♥ loser.

You probably cannot avoid your 3 ♦ losers, but you may be able to get out with losing a single trump. **IF** ♠s split 3-2, and **IF** you can win tricks with both the ♠K and ♠Q then you will make it. The only way it can happen is if North holds a doubleton ♠ A x. You must play the first ♠ from dummy, so ruff a ♣ to get there, then lead a small ♠, putting on your ♠Q when North follows low. This wins the trick, (hip-hip), so you now play your ♠3, ducking in dummy. When North has to take his ♠A, (hooray), you are home-free.

With North holding the ♠A, this Plan clearly works.

But, if you need North to hold the ♠ A x anyway, perhaps that first plan would have worked better. You know, take dummy's ♣Q, then play a low ♠ to get to your hand.

It depends on North. If he ducked the low ♠ then you could get **TWO** discards and make an overtrick.

The method given here gives up the possibility of an overtrick for an improved chance of making the contract. You choose.